

# MinuteMind AI

## Meeting Report

Date: 2026-05-18

Time: 13:07:10

Meeting Topic: Adoption of the 2025 Financial Plan

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### 1. Meeting Transcript

[00:00 - 05:00]

I'll start again. This is the meeting for the Armour Springfield, a special meeting to discuss our 2025 financial plan. Today's date is April the 29th at 2025, and the time is exactly 6 p.m. I'm Mayor Patrick Tarian for the Arm of Springfield. All council is present. To my right, the sending order is Glenn Fuel, Andy Kaczynski, Mark Miller, and Melinda Warren. If I can get an adoption of the agenda there, I'll move on to secondary, please. Melinda and Glenn in additions from council at all I see none if I can get a mover or those in support of the adoption of the agenda many that would be unanimous and is therefore passed We get into 4 that adoption of the 2025 financial plan. Can I get a mover and a seconder for that as well, please? Melinda and Patrick? The Resolve that Council of the Arm of Springfield adopt the 2025 financial plan consisting of one, an operating budget, two, a capital budget, three, an estimate of operating revenue and expenditures for the following fiscal year, and four, a five-year capital expenditure program. Thank you. Questions? Councillor Miller? No, that's the same. No we can hear Unmute. Does that work? Okay, sorry about that. Just a couple of comments and questions. First one to the CEO or CFO. Under Section 3.304, subsection 1, no later than May 15th of each year, this is the Municipal Act, after adopting its operating budget for the year, Council must by by-law set a rate of taxation. So I assume that in the next coming meetings, we're going to have a by-law to adopt the financial plan? Yeah, we pass a financial plan by resolution, and then that becomes Schedule A to the by-law for the taxation. Thank you for that clarity. A few concerns I have I wanted to share with Council with this particular proposed 2025 financial plan. I noted at least one resident got back to me. Actually, there's a couple of them or a few that had input questions to our council. But as you know we don't have question period we don't have delegations and we really have no mechanism for the public to engage with us But this one individual as you know it in our agenda kind of hidden from the public but this one individual did submit comments to the CAO and expressed that those comments be, how can I say, publicly known. So I'm just wondering when people submit comments, because again, we've eliminated question period. We don't really have delegations to this special meeting. So there's no opportunity for the public to engage with us at all. But yet this individual took the effort to do, I think, a two or three page exposition or series of questions for the financial plan. But yet when they submitted them online, this individual had the understanding that they would be posted publicly for people to share his concerns or maybe even respond to them. But I think you know who I'm referring to. I'm not sure if that individual wants me to say their name, but I'm just wondering when people submit comments, wasn't that supposed to be the mechanism where the public still has the opportunity to publicly have their concerns shared with the community? In other words, are we just now relying on Oak Bank rant and rave?

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for the community to engage with us. This seems to be really the only mechanism. I'm kind of frustrated at that because people are now calling me and saying, Mark, other than you expressing our concerns at these meetings, there's no

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ability for the public to engage with not only the bureaucracy, but with council in general. And so for some council members, they feel it's gone on deaf ears. In other words, they share those concerns with council representatives, but they don't bring them up. They don't share them and they don't respond to them. And so they feel very frustrated. They feel that the only mechanism now, the only mechanism they have now are two things. One, to institute recall legislation, which of course won't happen very quickly. And the second is to vote differently at the next election in October of 2026. So it's unfortunate we've come to this situation where the public really is relegated to the backwoods. And so my next point is with the provincial reassessment this year in 2025 we have an addition of million to our kitty And so we taken it upon us to find ways to spend that million And, you know, I came to council here wanting to sharpen my pencil as much as I could, not to cut indiscriminately, but to save taxpayers' dollars on discretionary items. In other words, things that are not necessarily for the clear benefit of the rate payers of our community. And I've tried to do that. But like in any democracy, if they don't flow with the rest of those who vote for those things, they end up in the dungeon and don't get passed. So I would suggest that with this proposed budget, I personally have seen that I'm going to have an 18% increase in my municipal taxes. 18%. And I don't have the biggest house in our municipality. I guarantee you that. My neighbor across the street has a house worth at least five times mine. And they're going to go ballistic if their rate increases 18%. Now I know that not the average but some people are gonna have 20 some are are going to have 2 Some are going to have 8 They going to wonder and ask us the question where are we spending this money Why is we got \$2 million extra because of the reassessment, but yet we're spending that like, I want to be cautious in what I say, but we're spending it just because we have it. And so we've got some very important and critical projects coming forward, as we all know. And we have to address those. So I would like our council to set a goal of reducing expenditures going forward, not increasing them just because we have an influx of \$2 million, because next year, we're not going to have that \$2 million extra kitty. and if our expenses keep rising the way they are, you know, people are stretched to the limit. We saw it in the election yesterday. Affordability and cost of living is the top priority for all political parties. Whether they really address it or not, that's another issue. But we have to, on the grassroots here in the municipality, realize that people don't have an endless credit card to spend money with I not going to go on a rant here but anyway you kind of get the gist of where I going Thank you Thank you Councillor Miller I just want to remind people in the audience that there's no recording allowed there. Does anybody understand that? Thank you. Any other questions from Council? Councillor Kaczynski? Yes, thank you. I would like to point out, Councillor Miller, that it's not \$2 million, but it's \$3.2 million we're going to receive from that 18% increase by reassessment of our houses. 3.3, Councilor Kaczynski. 3.3? Okay. That's even better. So I will echo your comments and your concern that we have to be really frugal with our money right now. Because not gonna happen all the time that we're gonna get that reassessment because province have to realize that people only have so much money to spend. And the gravy train gonna be over shortly. So that's my concern and my input. Thank you. Thank you very much, Councillor Kaczynski. Any other questions or comments from council?

[10:00 - 15:00]

So I'd just like to kind of clarify or summarize everything that, as the chair, allows me this opportunity to do so. The mechanisms for this budget were totally complied with there. we did have our planning hearing or the public hearing there last week, I believe, there and all the questions were answered. I know who you were talking to and I don't know whether you mentioned his name or not. I'm not sure whether I can or not, but I won't. And those questions were answered by me on the record there. So they're like, I think they were referred to as flags or something like that. So I

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answered all those questions there and it was the questions were answered by, or the answers were provided by administration that weren't answered at the time of the hearing itself there. So I do understand the situation that both councillors were talking about, Kaczynski and Miller and I totally understand you know I don't know that an RM is as strong a position as ourselves. We have a very good financial position there, and it shows in the progress the steps that we're taking. But we don't take it furiously. We went through each one of these, as you know, through our committee of the wholes and working groups there. We went detail by detail, line by line, and saved where we can. And, you know, the wants as opposed to the needs, they're all weighed. So we rely quite heavily on our directors for their budgets. We give them something at the beginning of the year. And everybody does an exceptional job with that money. And they know it's the taxpayers' money. It's most of them are the taxpayers within the arm of Springfield themselves. So the increase, as Councillor Miller has stated, I forget what Councillor Miller was saying for his increase there, whether you said it or not, I'm not sure. But mine went up 21%. Of course I going to be paying a price for that. My neighbours we had discussions about that. And unfortunately that out of our control with the assessment year being this year. Yes we got a pretty good amount of money. We got a pretty good amount of money two years ago. I think we got \$2.2 million two years ago. Things change and so on like that. So we're able to reduce our mill rate by 3.1 per 6 excuse me, reduce it 3.16. So it's not going to help a lot of the taxpayers there. And that's on average a 17% increase within the arm of Springfield. Some, you know, might even pay a little bit less there, but it's going as high as 21%. And that, that would be myself and my neighbors around me there. So I, I do understand the concerns from councillors, Councillors Miller, Kaczynski there and just to reiterate there everybody does have an input into the into this the budget and that was expressed quite eloquently by several people there that came up to us last week as well as as time goes on there. Everybody has a chance to discuss this through delegations and questions through their councillors myself and I answer every question there. But that's all I have to say to summarize all that. Any other questions from council at all? Deputy Mayor? Yeah, I'd just like to say that we did a really good job in working through this budget. and we like I said I said at time before that we went through this budget and went and reduced the mill rate once went back the second time and even became lower the second time and again all administration put their hearts into this to make it work and I agree that all administration and staff that are involved in the budget take it seriously with every resident's dollar and they Mayor Mrakas, We do the best they can and costs are going up wherever we look and we know that and we're doing the best we can. Mayor Mrakas, So this budget to me is a good budget and we got a plan for the future and that's what we're doing, because these costs and everything is not going down to keep going up, thank you. Mayor Mrakas, You can also. Councillor John Gallo, Thank you, Mr. Bear it's good, we have a Council, because we have different voice of you I wouldn't.

[15:00 - 17:19]

necessarily agree with the deputy mayor in this particular situation. I think we can do better. I think it ain't or a 17% average increase. If the public knew that they would go ballistic. They would not be embracing us. In fact, they would be very upset and they would be saying you ought to look line by line one more time, one sober second thought, because despite costs going up and we can use that excuse, everybody seems to, but in all due reality, Manitobans aren't getting paid that much more and we're getting squeezed right to the the you know the nines and so I think uh there is improvement to make and I cannot support uh this budget proposed as it is because I think we can use the excuse that the people had an opportunity for a public open house but again if we put it by if we put up the information very clearly that it was going to lead to a 17% increase, I think you'd have this room packed and packed and packed because people

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are fed up and aren't going to put up with this anymore. And we'll see it in October of 26. Thank you Councillor There any other questions I see none We can read the resolution We can vote on it Yes, please. Do you resolve that Council of the Arm of Springfield adopt the 2025 financial plan consisting of, one, an operating budget, two, a capital budget, three, an estimate of operating revenue and expenditures for the following fiscal year, and for a five-year capital expenditure program. With a show of hands, first, those in support. That'll be Councillor Warren, Deputy Mayor Fuel, and Mayor Tarian. Those opposed? Councillors Miller and Kaczynski, so passed. Unless there's any other questions from council? I see none. Then propose to adjourn. Can I get a mover and a seconder to adjourn? Thank you very much, Councilor Melinda and Melinda Warren and Deputy Mayor Fuel. And at 6.17 p.m., the meeting is adjourned. Thank you very much, people, for attending and the audience and online and the councils.

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## 2. Meeting Summary

The meeting was held to discuss and adopt the 2025 financial plan for the Arm of Springfield. The council members discussed the proposed budget, which includes an operating budget, capital budget, and a five-year capital expenditure program. Some council members expressed concerns about the 17% average increase in municipal taxes and the lack of public engagement mechanisms. Despite these concerns, the council voted to adopt the 2025 financial plan.

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## 3. Key Discussion Points

- The proposed 2025 financial plan and its potential impact on taxpayers
  - The lack of public engagement mechanisms, such as question period and delegations
  - The 17% average increase in municipal taxes and its potential effects on residents
  - The need for frugal spending and reducing expenditures
  - The importance of public input and transparency in the budgeting process
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## 4. Action Items

- Mayor Patrick Tarian -> Ensure that the adopted financial plan is implemented and monitored
  - Council members -> Review and analyze the budget to identify areas for cost savings and reduction
  - Administration -> Provide regular updates on the budget and its implementation
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## 5. Minutes of Meeting (MoM)

Topic: Adoption of the 2025 Financial Plan

Attendees: Mayor Patrick Tarian, Councillor Glenn Fuel, Councillor Andy Kaczynski, Councillor Mark Miller, Councillor Melinda Warren, and other council members

Discussion: The council discussed the proposed 2025 financial plan, including the operating budget, capital budget, and five-year capital expenditure program. Concerns were raised about the lack of public engagement mechanisms and the

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potential impact of the 17% average increase in municipal taxes on residents.

Decisions Taken: The council voted to adopt the 2025 financial plan, with Councillors Warren, Fuel, and Mayor Tarian in support, and Councillors Miller and Kaczynski opposed. The meeting was adjourned at 6:17 p.m.

6. Next Meeting Details (Optional)

Date:

Time: